1

Meaning and Nature of Curriculum

CHAPTER OUTLINE

- Meaning, Definitions and Elements of Curriculum
- Stages of Curriculum Development
- Changing Conceptions of Curriculum
- Hidden Curriculum

MEANING, DEFINITIONS AND ELEMENTS OF CURRICULUM

Meaning of Curriculum

The meaning of curriculum changes with the philosophies and trends of that time. There is as such no consensus for a uniform meaning of curriculum or definition of curriculum. In order to develop a comprehensive view and understanding, it is apt to explore various viewpoints of the meaning of curriculum. Let us try to understand:

- What is curriculum?
- What is the purpose of curriculum?

The literal meaning of curriculum is derived from the Latin word *currer*, meaning chariot race, runway or path, laid way to reach the goal.

In other words, it is sum of all the good learning experiences that pupils have in order to achieve the goals of education which determine the direction of these experiences.

Curriculum can be defined as a plan of action or a written document that includes strategies for achieving desired goals or ends.

The above view is popularized by Hilda Taba and Ralph Tyler, which means the steps are planned in advance.

The word 'curriculum' from its early Latin origin literally means 'to run a course'. Oliver (1997) has analysed curriculum as:

- Something which is taught in schools
- A set of subjects
- Content
- A programme of studies
- A set of materials
- A sequence of courses
- A set of performance objectives

It is everything that goes on within the school, including extra-class activities, guidance and interpersonal relationships:

- Everything that is planned by school personnel
- A series of experiences undergone by learners in a school
- Anything that an individual learner experiences as a result of schooling (Oliva:1997:04)

Generally, any plan notes with a beginning, completes with an end and the process in between. This view is also approved and accepted by J. Galen Saylor which is reflected in the definition of curriculum: 'a plan for providing sets of learning opportunities for persons to be educated'.

Similarly, David Pratt defines curriculum as an 'organized set of formal education and/or training intension'.

In a similar fashion, Jon Miles and Joseph Bondi also viewed 'curriculum as a plan for learning where objectives determine what learning is important'.

The above definitions from different perspectives are defined in limited or narrow sense.

From a broader connotation rooted from Dewey's view, curriculum can be defined as 'dealing with the experiences of learners'. It considers almost everything in the school, even outside the school as a part of curriculum; it is expressed similarly from Carewell and Campbell's perspective as 'all the experiences that children have under the guidance of teachers'.

Even Shepherd and Ragen defined that 'curriculum consists of the ongoing experiences of children under the guidance of the school. It also represents a special environment for helping children achieve self-realization through active participation within the school'.

For Eisner, curriculum 'is a program the school offers to its students'. It consists of a preplanned series of educational hurdles and an entire range of experiences of a child has within the school.

Hass in a comprehensive way defines, 'Curriculum is all of the experiences that individuals have in a program of education which is planned in terms of theory and research or past and present professional practice'.

According to McNeil, Schubert and Tanner, curriculum can also be viewed as a field of study consisting its own foundations and domains of knowledge as well as its own research, theory, principles and its own specialists to interpret this knowledge.

Fundamentally, many considered curriculum to be subject matter (math, science, history, English and so on) or the content (the way we organize and assimilate information).

Finally, Beauchamp asserts that only definitions involving a plan, system and field of study representative key or legitimate uses of the word 'curriculum'.

Definitions of Curriculum

- It is the totality of experiences a child experiences in the school. It consists of that series of things which children and youth must do, aid experience by way of developing ability to do things well that make up the affairs of adult life. —Bobbit
- It is the total effort of the school to bring about desired outcomes in and out of school situation. —Alexander and Saylor
- It is a sequence of potential experiences set up in school for the purpose of disciplining children and youth in group ways of thinking and acting. —Smith, Stanley and Shores
- Whatever the mode of expression, the subject matter is the substantive hard core of the curriculum. —Beauchamp

- Curriculum is concerned not with what students will do in the learning situation, but what they will learn as a consequence of what they do. —Johnson
- Curriculum is a tool in the hands of the artist (teacher) to mould his material (student) in his studio (school). —Cunnigham
- Curriculum includes all the learning experiences offered to all the learners under the direction of the school. —C. Ronald
- All the learning experiences which are planned and guided by the school are called curriculum. —Brown Fraser
- The sum of all educational experiences that children have in school for the purpose of modifying learner's behaviour. —Kerth Lowell
- Curriculum is a body of prescribed educative experiences under school supervision designed to provide the individual with the best possible training and experiences to fit him for the society of which he is a part; and to qualify him for a trade or profession. —Carter V. Good
- Curriculum usually consists of a statement of aims and objectives indicating the selection and organization of content; it either implies or manifests certain patterns of learning and teaching. Because the objective demands or because the content organization requires, it includes a programme of evaluation of the outcomes. —Hilda Taba
- Curriculum is a runway which one has to run to reach a goal or a course of study. —Brubacher
- Curriculum is a strategy by which schools attempt to fulfil the goals of education. —Spalding
- Curriculum is defined as totality of experiences the pupil receives through manifold activities that go in the school, in the classroom, library, laboratory, workshops, playground and in the numerous informal contacts between the teacher and the pupil. —Secondary Education Commission
- It is a plan for action or a written document that includes strategies for achieving desired goals or ends. —Ralph Taylor and Hilda Taba
- As a plan for providing sets of learning opportunities for persons to be educated. —J. Galen Saylor
- Curriculum is an organized set of formal education and/or training intentions. —David Prett
- The discussion of curriculum is usually scholarly and theoretical, not practical and concerned with broad historical, philosophical or social issues. —M.C. Neil, Schubert and Tanner
- A plan, system and field of study represent key or legitimate uses of the word curriculum. —Beauchamp

Elements of Curriculum

Once we understood the basic meaning of curriculum through varied definitions proposed by educationists, it is apt to understand the design of curriculum. It is essential to know the basic elements and their relationships.

In any given curriculum, it is important to identify basic elements which are necessary. There is no consensus on these elements. However, Tyler identified the following three elements:

1. Learning experiences
2. Skills
3. Values and ideas

For taking an appropriate decision, the necessary and major elements need to be considered in the process of curriculum development. The decisions are related to the following:

1. Aims and objectives
2. Content
3. Learning experiences
4. Evaluation

Different designs of curriculum consider these elements but are not in balance, for example, subject-centric curriculum, experience curriculum and child-centric curriculum. The scope of the elements varies.

An effective design makes clear what the basis of selection of the various elements are, as well as the sources from which these criteria are derived. It should further distinguish which criteria apply to which element. For instance, the design should make it clear whether the objectives are derived from social needs, individual needs or adequate knowledge related to school subjects, based on which the choice is made about the content and its organization.

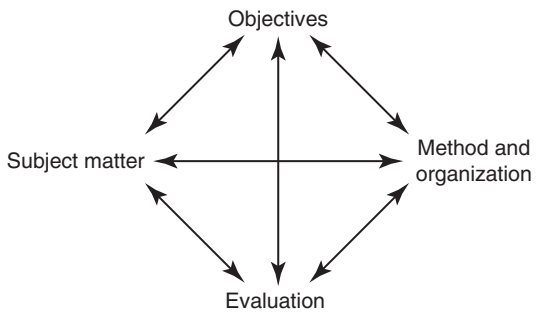
Whenever the rationale behind the design is defective, problems such as having a gap between the theory and practice occur. With the changing needs, demands and cultural needs, the nature of student population is not easy to translate into curriculum design. So, the task should be taken up on war-footing basis in terms of curriculum revision and a periodic reshuffling of the entire scheme, then regular adoption.

Now, let us try to understand the relationship between the elements mentioned earlier.

Relationships among the Elements For any curriculum design, the relationship between different elements and the criteria or consideration related to them should be clear. There is a possibility of one element having an impact and influence on the other element. Based on the objective, the subject matter is selected. For example, if the objective is to develop citizenship, then it is important to develop the ability to think critically. This demands certain specific learning experiences which in turn also expect methods and evaluation procedures suitable to the other elements.

Considering nature and background of the students and establishing sequence of learning experiences suitable to the subject and the discipline, all the elements of curriculum design need to be taken care of. The essence of every subject needs to be reflected.

The diagrammatic representation is as follows:



In the above diagram (from the eight-year study by Gilers, McCutcheon and Zectiel, 1942), the curriculum design is shown with four elements, i.e. objectives, subject matter, method and organization, and evaluation. In a way, the design prompts the curriculum designer to raise four questions while designing the curriculum:

1. What is the purpose to be done?
2. What is the subject matter to be selected?
3. What methods and organization to be employed?
4. How to appraise/assess the results?

Since these four elements are interdependent and get influenced by the other, any decision about any element will be dependent on the other.

The design always depends on the pattern of curriculum that is planned. All the principles criteria have equal significance in designing a curriculum.

Generally, the criteria of efficiency and economy are considered while designing.

STAGES OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

In developing either a teaching/learning unit or an integrated curriculum, varied decisions are made to work out a realistic curriculum by incorporating all the principles of good curriculum.

The methodology to plan either a unit or total curriculum is to break down the systematic steps to ensure orderly thinking, to make possible a systematic study of the elements that compare such a plan, and to provide for a precise and careful study and application of the relevant principles and facts.

According to Hilda Taba, the steps followed in developing a unit or curriculum are as follows:

1. Diagnosing needs
2. Formulating specific objectives
3. Selecting content
4. Organizing content
5. Selecting learning experiences
6. Organizing learning experiences
7. Evaluating
8. Checking for balance and sequence

Step 1: Diagnosing Needs

Before planning the curriculum, diagnosis helps in general analysis of problems, conditions and difficulties. The purpose is to generate a new emphasis and new ideas about the curriculum, by knowing thoroughly from various sources such as students' cumulative records, teachers' recordings, parents' interviews, children's cases and their IQ achievement.

This kind of analysis of various aspects would lead to come out with a new conception of curriculum. Diagnosis leads to understand the prime needs at different stages of curriculum.

Step 2: Formulating Specific Objectives

The above diagnosis will provide some clues to formulate necessary objectives and lead to generate richer learning.

The objectives will be very comprehensive on the following:

1. Concepts or ideas to be learnt
2. Attitudes, sensitivities and feelings to be developed
3. Ways of thinking to be reinforced, strengthened or initiated
4. Habits and skills to be mastered

Based on the diagnosis, the specific objectives are related to the concepts, ideas necessary to learn at a stage, particular aspect of thinking, attitudes, skills and so on.

Step 3: Selecting the Content

Based on the diagnosis of needs and tentative projection of objectives, it is much easy to go for the content selection. The objectives and needs provide a basic idea and guidance to select the relevant content.

While selecting the content, the following to be planned meticulously:

- Selecting the topics
- Selecting the basic ideas
- Selecting the specific content

The first task is to select the relevant topics through which the objectives formulated can be achieved unit by unit; the topics have to be finalized.

What are different topics which can be covered under each subject, class and level. Then the idea needs to pay attention to incorporate into the broad content. To suit the idea and topics, the specific content is planned to finalize the broad areas under the curriculum.

Step 4: Organizing the Content

Once the content is finalized, the content has to be organized systematically by keeping in view the following:

- Sequential order
- Concrete to abstract
- Simple to complex
- Known to unknown
- Immediate to remote
- Easy to difficult

In other words, it should follow inductive logical arrangement of the content and a psychological sequence. There should be connection between ideas, facts and relationships.

Steps 5 and 6: Selecting and Organizing Learning Experiences

With the content in hand, it is easy to plan for learning experiences or activities.

The criteria with which the content is drawn should provide/plan/visualize what students need to experience in order to acquire certain behavioural competencies and sequence of the experiences.

Care must be taken to include a variety of learning – reading, writing, observing, doing research, analysing, discussing, tabulating, painting and absorption.

The learning experiences are expected to be:

1. Introduction, Opener, Orientation Generally, viewing at learning experiences, at least three main stages should be involved. The learning strategies/activities introduced are essentially (1) introductory, (2) for opening up and (3) for orientation.

These include the following activities:

1. Provide diagnostic evidence for the teacher
2. Help the students make a connection with their own experience
3. Arouse interest
4. Provide concrete descriptive data
5. Create involvement and motivation

By following the above approach, learning experiences can be selected and organized to facilitate learning.

While teaching any unit, students can be involved actively and help them to make a connection to their personal experiences, connect to the community or share the experiences of their parents. Thus, the teacher plans learning experiences by allocating tasks which are useful for the students and discusses the methods by which to do.

2. Development, Analysis, Study Here, the teacher plans learning experiences by developing various dimensions of the subject, for instance, reading, researching, then analysing the data, studying various kinds and finding the answers to their questions planned for their study.

3. Generalization After developing the skills of analysis and study, students will be able to generalize by putting together all the ideas and reformulate them in their own way.

For instance, by studying the tribal culture and the migration of that population, they come out with certain generalizations about the ethnic groups.

4. Applications, Summary, Culmination Finally, the activities are designed to apply what has been learnt, to asses and evaluate and set into a larger framework.

5. Rhythm of Learning Activities In some of the curriculum patterns, some or the other mental activity is defectively developed that creates problems in intake period, assimilation without integration, inhibits new learning and burdens memory. A balanced curriculum is one where learning is balanced, which offers opportunities for mastery of knowledge and helps in internalization. It requires disciplined knowledge, analysis and reflection. Thus, the rhythm of building feelings and meanings is also important. For instance, while climbing the staircase, there is a need to balance the foot while going upwards; similarly, while teaching a new skill, it is wise to use known material, and when teaching new ideas, it is wise to use familiar skills. Thus, the curriculum decisions based on good diagnostic evidence meet students' interests and needs more adequately than do students' own unenlightened insights.

Step 7: Evaluating

As we know evaluation is determining the objectives, diagnosis or establishment of baseline for learning and appraising progress and changes, there are varied approaches and methods of

evaluation to know the progress of the child. Mostly, evaluation is in a way continuous diagnosis along with the comparison of results. Even several informal devices can also be used to evaluate the outcomes of the unit and curriculum on the whole. Finally, whether the objectives of curriculum are achieved needs to be evaluated.

Step 8: Checking for Balance and Sequence

After completing unit by unit and the whole curriculum, it is necessary to check the overall consistency among its parts or individual aspects. Every aspect needs to be checked—whether the core ideas are reflected in the content, whether the suitable learning experiences are planned for the content and whether the overall achievement of objectives is planned for the overall progress of the topic.

On the whole, a proper sequence is maintained logically and there is balance in the overall design of the curriculum.

Thus, these are the basic steps necessary while designing a unit and on the whole curriculum is related to a subject or discipline, etc.

CHANGING CONCEPTIONS OF CURRICULUM

There are no consensuses about the conception of curriculum from the traditional to that of modern educationists. However, there are varied conceptions and understanding of the concept of curriculum. Nobody knows what is right and what is wrong, with changing demands and aspirations of the larger social framework, and predicts the kind of curriculum. At the same time, varied perspectives will emerge and are appreciated by different sectors of the society.

For instance, even today in the so-called modern technologically advanced society, some of them are in favour of idealistic, conventional disciplinarian practices. Others believe in progressive, ideological, child-centric and radical, approaches to curriculum.

The following discussion, according to Tanner and Tanner (1975), opens up a plethora of viewpoints or conceptions on curriculum:

1. Curriculum as the cumulative tradition of organized knowledge
2. Curriculum as modes of thought
3. Curriculum as race experience
4. Curriculum as experience
5. Curriculum as guided learning experience
6. Curriculum as guided living
7. Curriculum as an instructional plan
8. Curriculum as a technological system of production
9. Curriculum as ends
10. Perennialist conceptions of curriculum
11. Essentialist conceptions of curriculum

Curriculum as the Cumulative Tradition of Organized Knowledge

During the early twentieth century, modern educationists considered traditional curriculum as a body of subjects or subject matter which a teacher has to teach to the learner. Whereas traditionalists viewed curriculum as a fixed body of subjects where it is not possible to either add or delete any subjects. They focused on permanent or essential studies suggested by perennialist and essentialist conceptions (See Chapter 3 for more details).

Curriculum as Modes of Thought

Disciplinary Inquiry In terms of disciplinary issues of concern, qualitatively there is no distinction between the child's intellectual activity and the scholarly specialists. It is defined by Phenix that 'education should be conceived as a guided recapitulation of the process of inquiry which gave rise to the fruitful bodies of organized knowledge comprising the established disciplines'. However, in Belth's words 'curriculum is considered to be the increasingly wide range of possible modes of thinking about men's experiences – not the conclusions, but the models from which conclusions derive, and in the context of which these conclusions, these so-called truths, are grounded and validated'.

In a way modes of thinking from broader view of curriculum, as extending beyond the confines of the established disciplines, thereby extending curriculum significantly beyond Phenix's conception, Belth feels curriculum as 'a matter of developing the power to use the models of a variety of disciplines', and the condition is the ability to sort out many conceptions about the methods of inquiry indigenous to each of the separate disciplines.

There were a set of misconceptions among the leading educators, and they could not distinguish between Dewey's conception of reflective thinking and disciplinary inquiry–discovery embraced in the discipline-centred curriculum, which gave a death blow to the traditional notion of separation of content and process, whereas Dewey felt it is necessary to have a unity between content and process, subject matter and method. He also cautioned that disciplinary studies may lead to the danger of isolation of intellectual activity from the regular life.

Reflective Thinking Dewey did not confine curriculum to modes of thought, but he could see the reflective thinking as a means to bring curricular elements together. He feels reflection is not restricted to specialized knowledge, but it is also related to social problem solving.

According to Dewey, the following are essentials of reflection:

1. Pupils have a genuine situation of experience. Students will go on with continuous activity.
2. Within the situation, a genuine problem develops as a stimulus to a thought.
3. They possess information and collect the observation to deal with it.
4. Solutions occur to them and will take the responsibility to put in an order.
5. They get the opportunity and occasion to test their ideas by application.

However, the above suggestion of Dewey was misunderstood and misinterpreted as mandatory. Dewey never said that one can direct somebody's thought. He said that it is not possible to separate thought and action and thinking and doing.

The whole idea of reflection is to act in one's own life situation. He felt curriculum as more than the transmission of established modes of thought and the validity of so-called truths within the disciplinary boundaries.

Curriculum as Race Experience

Perennialist and essentialist educators feel curriculum as a cumulative tradition of knowledge, but curriculum also includes the total culture of a society. Dewey's view of reconstruction of experience can be seen in Smith, Stanley and Shores' definition of curriculum: a sequence of potential experiences is set up in the school for the purpose of disciplining children and youth in group ways of thinking and acting.

In Dewey's view, race experience is not an end itself but a turning point in the continuous reconstruction of knowledge and society. He also expressed progressive view that curriculum is an 'endeavor to shape the experiences of the young so that instead of reproducing current habits, better habits shall be formed, i.e., the future adult society could be a better and improved one'.

Lawton, a British educator, views curriculum as 'a selection from the culture of society', i.e. certain aspects of our way of life, certain kinds of knowledge, certain attitudes and values are regarded as so important that their transmission to the next generation cannot be left to chance. No doubt this was entrusted to educators to select and place in the schools. Although Lawton is comprehensive in defining, the question here is, is it mere selection or reconstruction of the culture? Is it mere transmission or cultural improvement?

With the explosion of knowledge, there is regular revision of curriculum and inclusion of subjects and displacement of some subjects and so on.

Gradually, there is an increasing specialization of knowledge which is creating a wide gap between personal and social needs and problems.

Curriculum as Experience

Traditional conception of curriculum dominated subject/knowledge. This view was under the protest by progressivists. They claimed the subject-centric curriculum should consider the needs of existing community life. It should improve the life by making future better than the past (Dewey).

Child-Centred-versus-Subject-Centred Rationale With an agony to see that curriculum is made more relevant to life experience of the learner, romantic progressivists have gone to the extent to make virtually all the school activities.

In between these two extreme misconceptions – on one head subject is fixed where the child is docile and on the other hand the child is the beginning, end, and centre of attractions – *Dewey* says that the human race experience also supports and the child is not docile; it has to be visualized as 'fluent embryonic, vital' where the curriculum develops the child's present experience to a richer maturity, where we need to abandon the idea of the two extremes and where subject matter is fixed and ready-made in itself outside the child's experience.

He feels that the child and the curriculum are two limits, and this is a single process like two points which make a straight line.

During 1960s and 1970s, it was a demand for learner-centred curriculum. Abandoning planned curriculum and learning everything to the child's natural development lead to a set crisis. Dewey clarified through his philosophy, 'When personal fulfillment is served from intellectual activity, "freedom of self-expression" turns into something that might better be called "self-exposure"'.

Curriculum as Guided Learning Experience

According to Foshay's observations, during late 1930s the term 'curriculum' was defined as 'all the experiences a learner has under the guidance of the school'. Many curricularists have agreed and continued with similar definitions. Even during 1920s Borner defined curriculum as the 'experiences in which pupils are expected to engage in school, and the general order of sequence in which these experiences are to come'.

Casewell and Campbell, in 1935, stated that the curriculum is composed of all the experiences children have under the guidance of teachers. The 1942 eight-year study report has concluded that the curriculum is seen as the 'total experience which the school deals in educating young people'.

Gradually, there was a breakthrough from the traditional definition in a broader connotation that what pupils learn is not limited to the formal course of study but is affected, directly and indirectly, by the total school environment, i.e., guided school experience.

The implication can be drawn from the definition that 'everything that influences the learner must be considered during the process of curriculum making'.

Although the above definitions reflect that learning takes place under the guidance of school and teachers, the learner may encounter with desirable as well as undesirable experiences sometimes and fail in making clear distinction of achievable objectives.

Further in 1946, Spears observed that 'the concept of curriculum had broken loose from its academic moorings and moved on out into the total program of activities that was to serve the individual learner while under the guidance of the school'.

Tylerian definition encompasses educational objectives and all planned learning experiences; in his view curriculum is 'all of the learning of students which is planned by and directed by the school to attain its educational goals'.

In 1962, Alberty and Alberty described curriculum as 'all of the activities that are provided for students, by the school'. They also pointed out that 'it is by means of these activities that the school hopes to bring about changes in the behavior of students in terms of its philosophy and goals'.

Most significantly, the concept of curriculum as guided learning experience conceives of the teaching-learning process is integral to curriculum. There is not much mention made of knowledge in most of the definitions.

Earlier definitions of curriculum have viewed the courses of study as a part of curriculum, but the later have reduced it to mere courses of study.

Curriculum as Guided Living

In the words of Rugg in 1947, curriculum is 'the life and program of the school an enterprise in guided living', and the curriculum becomes the very stream of dynamic activities that constitute the life of young people and their elders.

However, Rugg's definition could not bring a continuity between the school and the life. It failed in making a clear distinction between school functions and those of the other social institutions. For instance, family can be considered as one of the enterprises in guided living.

Extra-class Activities From the traditional conception of curriculum, the rigid division between course work and other sponsored learning activities has been rejected in view of the broader conception of curriculum. The terms such as 'extracurricular' and 'co-curricular' have been dropped.

Gradually, many schools offered such activities as band, chorus, etc., as formal courses carrying academic credits. There was also a negation that these activities are not in the purview of intellectual training.

Many debates lead to the understanding that the extent to which extra-class activities can exert significant influences on cognitive as well as affective learning supports the contention that the school curriculum can be conceived of as more than the formal course of study.

The conception of curriculum as 'guided learning', or all experiences that learners have under the auspices of the school, or the planned learning experiences provided in the school setting is a radical departure from traditional conception of curriculum.

Curriculum as an Instructional Plan

Jerrold Zacharias (1964) proposed the curriculum which encompassed four distinct components:

1. Determining the precise boundaries of the educational unit
2. Identifying the subject matter within the unit
3. Embodying the subject matter in material form (textbook, laboratory and classroom materials and other learning aids)
4. Preparing teachers in the subject matter and use of materials

Paul Goodman noted that disciplinary movement was a return to the notion of curriculum as a course of study.

Taba (1962) rejected progressive concept of curriculum as non-functional and proposed that 'a curriculum is a plan for learning', whereas Beauchamp preferred a similar approach and said curriculum as a written document; however, he failed to distinguish it from other documents. He suggested that curriculum includes at least one of the four elements:

1. An outline of the culture content to be taught
2. A statement of goals and/or specific objectives
3. A statement of the purposes for the creation of curriculum and ways in which the curriculum is to be used
4. An appraisal scheme

Problem of Dualism The definitions of Taba and Beauchamp do not distinguish between a curriculum, a syllabus and a lesson plan, mere instruments of a curriculum.

The problem of dualism between curriculum and instruction arises in all definitions, where it is regarded as a plan.

Hirst also defines curriculum as 'a plan of activities deliberately organized so that pupils will attain, by learning, certain educational ends or objectives'.

On similar count, Alexander and Saylor defined curriculum as 'a plan for providing sets of learning opportunities to achieve broad goals and related specific objectives for an identifiable population served by a simple school center'.

Curriculum as a Technological System of Production

During the early twentieth century, the curriculum is considered as a production system. 'Scientific management' is applied to education. This can be seen in job analysis or activity analysis.

Activity Analysis It was popular during the twentieth century. This is a progressive idea of incorporating curriculum to life experience, job analysis or activity analysis designed to achieve educational objectives.

Franklin Bobbit and W. W. Charter developed this method of activity analysis. According to Bobbit, life consists of the performance of specific activities. If education is for life then it must prepare for such specific activities.

Curriculum as Ends

Popham and Baker define curriculum as 'all planned learning outcomes for which the school is responsible'. 'Curriculum refers to the desired consequences of instruction'. Curriculum is reduced to ends and instruction is reduced to means. Johnson also goes with idealistic who defines 'curriculum as planned learning experiences'. This could not distinguish between curriculum and instruction. Also, he defines curriculum as 'a structured series of intended learning outcomes'.

Popham says that curriculum and instruction should be sharply contrasted. The distinction is ends and means; in a production process the curriculum and the instruction are seen as two components.

There are various groups who debate on curriculum as ends, means, instruction or measurable product as behaviour.

Skinner and other behaviourists view curriculum as a component of technological production process and the learner as a mechanical unit in the production process.

Bush and Allen in their technological proposal for redesigning the high school offered that the 'entire curriculum can be thought of as an area to be scheduled'.

The entire technological orientation reduces curriculum to a rectangular box in which the variables included are the following:

1. The number of pupils to be processed
2. The time available for their processing

The entire discussion on curriculum and instruction under the doctrine of dualism as means and ends is that ends and means are continuous, as content and process.

Likewise many conceptions of curriculum were depicted. It could be considered as subject matter or content, a programme of planned activities, as intended learning outcomes, cultural reproduction, as discrete tasks and concepts, as an agenda for social reconstruction.

Thus, the varied conceptions from ancient to modern created a space to understand the meaning of curriculum.

Perennialist Conceptions of Curriculum

Perennialist conceptions are discussed in detail in Chapter 3.

Essentialists Concepts of Curriculum

Essentialist conceptions are discussed in detail in Chapter 3.

HIDDEN CURRICULUM

The concept of hidden curriculum, first treated as such by Overly (1970), has not been greatly refined in its brief lifespan, though it has been widely accepted; the term has been applied to specific classroom practices and used as a generic term referring to nearly everything that goes on in school. It is one of the few concepts in education which by its very name acknowledges the limits of understanding. It has been called various things, including the 'latent' or 'covert' curriculum, the 'non-academic outcomes of schooling', the 'by-product' or 'residue' of schooling

or the 'unstudied curriculum' (Overly, 1970), though it has been progressively more 'studied' in recent years.

The term 'hidden curriculum' was invented by Philip Jackson. Jackson was influenced by the educational psychology of the French philosopher Emile Durkheim who had 'the most philosophically and scientifically comprehensive, clear, and workable approach to moral education...' (Phillip Jackson Life in Classrooms 1968). Jackson invented the term 'hidden' or 'unstudied curriculum' refers to ninety percent of what goes on in classrooms – the curriculum of obligatory instruction. The hidden curriculum of the educational system reproduces the basic structure of the culture. The school's function of socialization is represented by three central characteristics of school life which teach the student to fit into a society of the same three characteristics – the crowds, the praise and the power. In school the student learns to be treated as a member of a crowd of same-age, same-status others and thus to fit into a world of impersonal authority in which a relative stranger gives orders and wields power.

The hidden curriculum refers to those practices and outcomes of schooling which, while not explicit in curriculum guides or school policy, nevertheless seem to be a regular and effective part of the school experience. The hidden curriculum may be viewed as covert, unintended, implicit or simply unacknowledged; the intentionality and the depth of the 'hiddenness' vary according to each writer's conception of the phenomenon, but generally the term describes those forces shaping the non-academic and unmeasured learnings of students. The term remains imprecise.

Traditional education is based on the premise that education depends on obligatory attendance in school. Children belong to school, they learn in school and they can only be taught in school and this type of schooling and teaching, as skill instruction confuses. The basic structure of the culture is reproduced in the 'hidden curriculum' of the educational system. Decisions about process as well as content are derived from value premises which underlie the political and social philosophies, 'schooling' with education and learning. The function of the hidden curriculum is to foster conformity to the cultural values. Students are taught how to be consumers of the services of 'teaching'. They are taught how to accept its inherent cultural values and expectations. They are taught how to blend in with the cultural belief systems.

Educational practices treated as a part of the hidden curriculum include ability grouping, teacher/pupil relationships, classroom rules and procedures, implicit textbook content, sex-role differentiation of pupils and classroom reward structures. Outcomes typically considered to be products of a hidden curriculum include political socialization, obedience, docility, the learning of values and cultural mores, the development of attitudes towards authority and the reinforcement of class distinctions.

The hidden curriculum by definition defies easy experimental treatment and clear cause–effect relationships, and is a kind of anomaly within the research tradition. It is even more curious that the hidden curriculum concept emerged at approximately the same time that behavioural objectives, 'measurable' outcomes and accountability were gaining currency in the United States, in the early 1970s, when evaluations of publicly funded education programmes demanded data that were replicable and valid. It is noteworthy that a single era should breed both scholars hopeful that educational change could be quantified and scholars eager to acknowledge that schools operate in mysterious ways. Both attitudes survive today; the appeal of the hidden curriculum seems undiminished.

Hidden curriculum requires a broader view and acknowledges that researchers are not quite certain what the variables are, much less, which are independent and dependent. The concept gives some clues depending on whether this hidden 'curriculum' is conceived to be a cause or effect, as to where to begin the search as new. The investigation seems typically to focus on one of these two meanings of the term.

Educators describing the hidden curriculum of schools in terms of its outcome include Henry's (1950) identification of 'docility' as a covert outcome of schooling, Illich (1971), and Bowles and Gintis (1976), who criticize the schools for maintaining social/class distinctions of capitalistic society, Apple and King (1977) and Anyon (1980) who argue that the different concepts of 'work' held by different social classes are partly a function of the school environment, and Vallance (1973/74) who argues that the hidden curriculum became 'hidden' when its goals of creating a relatively homogeneous American culture had been reached.

Discovering Hidden Curricula

In the classroom, different teachers may use the same text, yet each teacher provides a different outcome because of the emphasis given. Some may dwell upon the labour management conflicts in the history course. Another may stress the treatment of minorities. Some look at heroes, such as Washington, Jefferson and Lincoln as people to be honoured without question; others take a debunking attitude and point to their feet of clay.

Closely allied is the enthusiasm (or lack of it) on the part of individual teachers. A teacher can arouse interest in a subject through facial expression, tone of voice or an aura of sincerity. Another teacher can kill the same subject with a deadpan presentation or an attitude of 'here it is', take it or leave it. Little attention has been paid by teachers to the impact of their non-verbal behaviour – eye contact, position of arms, hand gestures and nodding.

Students acquire these hidden ideas while attending school. In many schools they still consist of social norms and values that 'schools promote' such as being punctual, competitive, waiting one's turn, learning to accept hierarchy of authority, patience and other 'goals and functions of the wider society' (Jackson, 1968).

School-promoted socializing codes of behaviour may adversely affect students and their learning. Teachers convey many messages to learners from the outset of their schooling. Michael Apple describes a situation in a kindergarten where the teacher controlled the children's behaviour and perception of the world in a negative way. According to Apple, the youngsters had to 'adjust their emotional responses to conform to those considered appropriate by the teacher' (Noel, 2000). Youngsters do not always feel at ease with being quiet and not being able to express their feelings. The hidden curriculum sometimes determines limitations to student's behaviour in the classroom and in the school which may be a hindrance to learning.

Education is concerned with the transmission and production of knowledge. The production of knowledge involves two aspects of educational practice or 'curricula'. One involves the knowledge itself or 'content'. The other involves the way in which the content is transmitted and produced, i.e. 'process'. The process is concerned with the methodology of teaching and learning or 'pedagogy'. Pedagogy is concerned with how one learns the content, how one makes decisions about who learns the content and to what extent they learn it. The curriculum of content is the 'overt curriculum'. The curriculum of 'process' is the 'unstudied curriculum' or 'hidden curriculum'.

According to Terry Anderson (2001), there are three historical ways of viewing an unwritten curriculum:

1. To mean a kind of indoctrination that attempts to maintain social privilege – or esoteric knowledge and practices – and that is imposed together with the formal, taught curriculum
2. To refer to the subtle effects of the setting in which formal education occurs
3. To refer to the unstated rules necessary for successful completion of formal education studies

Implications of Education

Both the overt curriculum and the hidden curriculum in any discussion should be considered in educational reform. Educational reform requires a fundamental change in the way children are educated, i.e., in the process of education. Teachers and schools, no matter how good, cannot do it alone. Parents can make the critical difference by taking an active role in children's education. Any reform in schooling has to deal with the absurdities of the system and expose the hidden curriculum. It is the hidden curriculum which combines consumer expectations with producers' beliefs in its claims and ritual. If people remain hypnotized by the power of ritual, it is only by breaking the spell that one can create changes which lead to reform. Hence, educational reform is possible if it is based not only on changes in the overt curriculum, but also on the changes in the hidden curriculum. The hidden curriculum is an educational process which lacks authenticity and depends on expectations for success. Reform depends on an educational process which is meaningful and depends for success on self-reliance and hope. What is needed is an educational philosophy that works. One philosophy which has been at the core of the education of the European ruling classes for years is based on the belief that the only basis of true knowledge is self-knowledge. In this system the family is the main arena for education. At every age children find themselves alone with a problem to solve. Children are trusted with independent study from a very early age. Their privacy and solitude is respected. Curricula are developed which enable children to cultivate self-knowledge and self-reliance. Their sense of responsibility is enhanced by making community service a part of their schooling, the understanding that the teacher is respected and children are not deprived of the time which they need to develop self-knowledge. Children who develop self-knowledge are capable of rational thought. They are able to apply the natural principles of social life to their own lives and they are able to mature and develop their own humanity (conscience) and the humanity of others.

The educational use of the 'hidden curriculum' is to bring the dialogue of justice into the classroom.

The hidden curriculum of obligatory instruction is justified by the constitutional principle of 'equal educational opportunity'. The function of the hidden curriculum is to foster conformity to the cultural values. The hidden curriculum as obligatory instruction or 'education' becomes obligatory attendance of obligatory schooling. Obligatory schooling revolves around teacher authority and student passivity. Life as obligatory schooling is based on student's classification according to age and performance on standardized tests. In the sorting process, students are expected to be obedient and passive, to work at meaningless tasks without complaint, to value competition and to respect their teachers as authority figures even though they are forced to remain weak and demoralized. In this way, the schools can pursue their objectives in the successful reproduction of cultural values which form the basis for the hidden curriculum. The hidden

curriculum serves to initiate the student into the culture of capitalism and consumerism by reproducing those cultural values which are compatible with it. The hidden curriculum transforms the non-material needs into demands for commodities. Students are taught how to be consumers of the services of 'teaching'. They are taught how to accept its inherent cultural values and expectations. They are taught how to blend in with the cultural belief systems.

Once they have learnt this lesson, they lose their incentive to grow in independence, to recognize relatedness and connection, and they disconnect themselves from opportunities which life has to offer. In this way the hidden curriculum prepares the student for a future of alienation and the institutionalization of life in a capitalist consumer culture. This is done through the three main characteristics of school life – the people, the praise and the power. In the life of 'school', the student learns to adapt to being treated as a same-age same-status member of a group, to obey the impersonal authority of strangers who give orders and wield power, to respond to the praise which is part of the rituals of schooling, i.e. school credentials and ceremonies such as diplomas, certificates, licenses, grades, honour's lists and graduations and to subscribe to the philosophy of 'accumulation'. As the philosophy of accumulation, the hidden curriculum of school and schooling is for the promotion of consumerism. As a promoter of consumerism, the schooling system performs the same three functions as powerful churches throughout human history. Like the church, the school is the repository of social myth; it serves to institutionalize the contradictions of that myth and it is the site of the ritual which hides and reproduces the discrepancies, disparities and conflicts existing between social principles and practical applications of those principles. At the same time, they are responsible for children's learning and growth. Schools create dependent personalities who are unable to draw on their own resources in order to give substance and pleasure to their existence. Unable to create meaningfulness for their own lives, children grow up absurd. In this education 'game', uncritical students focus on the content of the overt curriculum and become unaware of the other curriculum which is hidden in the process of teaching and learning that content. It is for this reason that the schooling system can be considered as a form of political manipulation (banking education). As obligatory instruction for institutionalized living, education of the hidden curriculum becomes an industry for the production of knowledge. The knowledge industry is a fast-growing labour market which directly or indirectly employs a growing proportion of the population. In the labour market, education is defined in terms of 'services' and institutions which are created for the services required for educating people. Many people are kept in school for life, or they are guaranteed to fit into some other forms of institution.